Mode Shifting Index (MSI)

Researchers should cite the following paper when using the scale:

Pringle, A. & Sowden, P. T. (2017). The Mode Shifting Index: A new measure of the creative thinking skill of shifting between associative and analytic thinking. *Thinking Skills and Creativity, 23, 17-28*. doi: http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.tsc.2016.10.010

The Mode shifting Index (MSI) is designed to assess individual differences in the creative thinking skill of shifting between associative and analytic modes of thought (see the referenced paper for details of the theory, development and initial validation of the MSI).

There are two versions of the MSI, one probes individual's mode shifting in their everyday context while the other probes individual's mode shifting in their professional context or as part of their current studies (i.e. university degree). Below is a copy of the MSI. Different instructions should be used for the two different contexts but the items themselves are identical across contexts.

MSI professional context- instructions:

"The following are some 11 statements about feelings, beliefs, and behaviours.
Please describe how true the statements are for you with respect to tasks you perform as part of your degree or in your current profession. Don't worry too much about any one item: first impressions are as good as any".

MSI everyday context- instructions:

"The following are some 11 statements about feelings, beliefs, and behaviours.
Please describe how true the statements are for you with respect to everyday tasks. Don't worry too much about any one item: first impressions are as good as any".

Scale:

1- Completely False
2- Mainly False
3- Undecided
4- Mainly True
5- Completely False

Questions (question order should be randomized, please note that the final MSI reported in Pringle & Sowden (2017) consists of 11 items):

- While working on a task, I often engage in focused in-depth thought during some phases and more intuitive thinking during others
- When working on a task, I like to think both in depth about the details and drift out of focus and let my mind wander (e.g. looking out of the window)
- I am good at tasks that require both logic and going with my gut feelings

- It seems I go through different phases of thinking through a task and accomplishing it from start to finish
- I rely on both careful reasoning and on my intuitive impressions
- I rely on both my intuition and logic when making important decisions
- I find that at times while working on a task my thinking and behaviour is driven more by my emotions and at other times it is driven more by reason and logic
- I find that at times while working on a task, I think or describe things using analogies or metaphors and at other times I don't use these and take a more reality-oriented view
- I am good at both figuring things out logically and going with my instincts when deciding on a course of action
- I find that I work best on certain problems when I am in a logical mind-set and best on others when my mind-set is less logical (e.g. more infused with emotions, unusual imagery, metaphors etc.)
- While working on a task, I go through phases where I do a lot of thinking and other phases where I just sit back and muse over things/take a back seat

The MSI is available as a Google Form and can be accessed using the following links (one link for each context). The Google Forms randomise question order automatically and data can is recorded within a CSV file upon submission.

Before using the MSI in the Google Forms format **please copy it to your Google drive**. Otherwise you will not be able to access the data from it. **Please also do not edit the forms in the links**, first copy the Google Forms to your Google Drive and then you can edit away as much as you like.

MSI professional context:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1aRK7xTvLmKCiXJ7wBbwV2C9W9TB5WSWBc8jDPtaid7w/edit?usp=sharing

MSI everyday context:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1vy8NIkQaSrnzovhC8goz6d27zlIDtOFYWHNcBGgWylY/edit?usp=sharing